Data Visualization Tools

Due to the rise of big data analytics, there has been an increased need for data visualization tools to help understand the data. Besides Tableau, there are several other software tools one can use for data visualization like Sisense, Plotly, FusionCharts, Highcharts, Datawrapper, and QlikView. This article is from Forbes and has a brief, clear introduction about these 7 powerful software options for data visualization. This could be helpful for future reference because for different purposes I may need to use different tools. Each option has its advantages and disadvantages and this article helps highlight them.

Brief Description of popular tools

Tool	Description
Tableau	The most popular in the group and has many users. It is simple to use, making it easy to learn and can handle large datasets. Tableau can handle big data thanks to integration with database handling applications such as MySQL, Hadoop, and Amazon AWS.
Qlikview	The main competitor to Tableau and also quite popular. Qlikview is customizable and has a wide range of features which can be a double-edged sword. These features take more time to learn and get acquainted with. However, once one gets past the learning curve, they have a powerful tool at their disposal.
FusionCharts	The distinctive aspect of FusionCharts is that graphics do not have to be created from scratch. Users can start with a template and insert their own data from their project.
Highcharts	It proudly claims to be used by 72% of the 100 biggest companies in the world. It is a simple tool that does not require specialized training and quickly generates the desired output. Unlike some tools, Highcharts focuses on cross-browser support, allowing for greater access and use.
Datawrapper	It is making a name for itself in the media industry. It has a simple user interface making it easy to generate charts and embed into reports.
Plotly	It can create more sophisticated visuals thanks to integration with programming languages such as Python and R. The danger is creating something more complicated than necessary. The whole point of data visualization is to quickly and clearly convey information.

Tool	Description
Sisense	It can bring together multiple sources of data for easier access. It can even work with large data sets. Sisense makes it easy to share finished products across departments, ensuring everyone can get the information they need.
Altair	It is a statistical visualization library for Python, based on Vega and Vega-Lite. Its sources are widely available on GitHub. With Altair, we can understand the data and its meaning in a better way. Altair's API is very simple to use. This is simple, elegant and produces beautiful and effective visualizations with a minimal amount of code.
Shiny	Shiny is an open package from RStudio, which provides a web application framework to create interactive web visualization called Shiny apps. The ease of working with Shiny has what popularized it among R users.
Microsoft Office	Microsoft Office uses a variety of tools and combined with their data source, excel, it can create simple, well designed, and intuitive graphs. Excel is a very popular took for viewing raw data, and there are tools within the program to create graphs based on the data.
Google Suite	Google Suite includes their docs, sheets, and slides (among others). Sheets is a great tool for holding raw data, similar to Excel. Within sheets, theres are simple tools to create graphs that quickly update based on the changing data. One significant quality Google Suite provides is the interactivity and availability for collaboration on the same documents.